

through the user's Internet connection without his knowledge. Spyware applications are typically bundled as a hidden component of freeware or shareware programs that can be downloaded from the Internet. So be careful when downloading free software. This is a huge menace on the Internet.

Once you know what could be coming to your system from the Internet, you can protect your computer from these alien codes. There are some very famous tricks to hack the system and commit cyber crimes. Hackers use various spoofing techniques, such as IP address spoofing, MAC (medium access control) address spoofing and URL spoofing. IP address spoofing is an attack whereby a system attempts to illicitly impersonate another system by using its IP network address.

Many hackers use MAC address

spoofing to change the manufacturer-assigned MAC address to gain entry into wireless LANs. There are many free tools available on the Internet for spoofing the MAC address.

URL spoofing exploits Web browser bugs in order to display incorrect URLs in the browser's location bar; or DNS (domain name system) cache poisoning in order to direct the user away from the legitimate site to the fake one. DNS helps to convert your text Web address into IP address. For example, when you type www.google.com in the browser, the browser sends this address to the nearest DNS to get, say, 200.200.10.10

Other famous tricks used by crackers to hack systems are SQL injection, mail bombs and buffer overflows. SQL (structured query language) injection is the name given to a general class of attacks that can allow nefarious users

to retrieve data, alter server settings or even take over your server if you are not careful. SQL injection is not a SQL server problem but a problem with improperly written applications. This can happen in the code of the database of your server.

E-mail bomb contains a large file or files designed to jam an ISP (internet service provider) server and/or the recipient's mail program. Once a bomb is opened, depending on the size of the file it contains, it can take hours to load. With many ISPs, a user's penalty for mail bombing is discontinuation of the service. Buffer overflows are caused when a program tries to store too much data in a temporary storage area. This can be exploited by hackers to execute malicious code. ●

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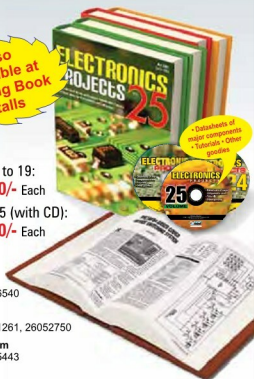
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